Cross-Discipline

Thematic Research

Date
22 July 2026

Time billionaires want more risk. Is AI to blame?

Luke Templeman, CPA
Research Analyst
+44-20-754-10130

Galina Pozdnyakova
Research Analyst
+44-20-754-74994

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Are you a time billionaire? Some say "yes" if they expect to have more than 1bn seconds (or about 31.5 years) ahead of them. And as the number of younger investors increases, and their time horizons span 30, 40, or 50 years, they want two things: 1) More risk than they have today, 2) AI to manage their money and trade for them.

So, is AI convincing investors, particularly young people, to increase their current level of investment risk? In this report, we use proprietary data from our dbDataInsights team to break down exactly who wants more investment risk and over what timeframe. We highlight that both Americans and Britons under the age of 55 are particularly keen to increase (relative to today) both their risk tolerance and their dependence on AI to manage their portfolio. The younger the age group, the more they say they will increase their risk over the coming 1, 3, and 5 years.

We then discuss various factors that are contributing to the increased desire for both risk and AI advice. Behavioural psychology feeds directly into the equation, particularly as 'social' investing has become a trend. 'Aspiration inflation' is also very tangible but we point out that young investors (and their risk appetite) are the product of the environment that has been created for them. In the end, there are pros and cons.

Several conflicts and conclusions come out of our work. The first is that it is intriguing that consumer sentiment is so low at the same time that the average person wants to take on more investment risk. A second is that this desire for risk at a household level comes as experts increasingly point to intensifying global systemic risks. A third is that the willingness to turn to AI for investment advice comes as the social winds against AI more broadly are growing in strength.

Appendix 1

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